



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Cor Deo School

School Website: <https://thecordeoschool.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Cor Deo School (Tacoma, WA, 98373) presents itself as a distinctly classical Christian school, with clear commitments to the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), a Great-Conversation orientation, Scripture-informed pedagogy, and active parent partnership. Public materials consistently emphasize truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable, a Christ-centered mission, and formation of character through a classical liberal-arts framework. Across six categories, the school demonstrates strong alignment with classical aims in religious foundations, purpose, curriculum, pedagogy, and community involvement. The only category with more tentative/partial alignment is Faculty, where the public materials reference administrators and staff and the broadened idea of “faculty and staff” but provide less explicit, text-level portrayal of the faculty as the living curriculum or as archetypes of virtuous teaching beyond standard roles. Overall classification: CLASSICAL.

Key insights: - Religious and metaphysical foundations are strongly evident through Christ-centered language, biblical instruction, and explicit references to truth, goodness, and beauty as real ideals. - Purpose and goal articulate formation, virtue, wisdom, and participation in the Great Conversation, with explicit emphasis on human excellence and timeless questions. - Curriculum is overtly classical (grammar/logic/rhetoric), the trivium, and the Great Books/Great Conversation orientation, plus explicit attention to history, classical languages (Latin), and memorization/chanting traditions. - Pedagogy foregrounds both contemplative/restful elements and rigorous Socratic-seminar-like engagement in upper grades, with lower grades engaging memory-focused, singing/chanting routines. - Community and parental partnership are explicit, with language about parent involvement, covenant-like relations, and access for visits and engagement. - The aggregate evidence supports a CLASSICAL ranking across categories, with Element 5 (Faculty) being the mildest departure from the strongest classical alignment.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents a Christ-centered mission and biblical framing (Christ at the center of all areas of life; biblical instruction connected to learning). - Public materials emphasize cultivating wisdom, virtue, and a deep faith in Christ as core aims. - References to truth, beauty, and goodness as core ideals and to a biblical worldview frame curricular and cocurricular life. - Connections to a church ministry (First Presbyterian Church Tacoma) and chapel spaces point to liturgical/community practice as part of education.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; Christ-centered; biblical instruction; theology-related framing; liturgical/community practices (chapel access). - Negative keywords: none evident in public materials (no relativism or secular-humanist signals detected in the public-facing text).

Why this rating - The materials consistently foreground transcendentals and religious commitments (truth, goodness, beauty, virtue) anchored in Christian faith, with explicit Biblical/theological framing. This strongly matches CLASSICAL expectations for religious and metaphysical foundations.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public texts emphasize formation of virtue and wisdom, not merely information, and frame education as formation toward human excellence. - The mission highlights cultivating wisdom, virtue, and a deep faith in Christ—all aligned with a classical telos beyond job preparation. - The school explicitly frames education as part of a Great Conversation and a pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty in a classical sense.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, classical mission, telos, great conversation, permanent questions, human excellence, moral imagination. - Negative keywords: absence of emphasis on 21st-century workforce/choreography signals; no job-prep framing detected in public materials.

Why this rating - The materials show a clear classical aim toward formation of character and wisdom, with explicit references to enduring ideals and to the Great Conversation, rather than a primary orientation toward career-readiness.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum centers on the Trivium: Grammar School (Kindergarten–6th), Logic School (7th–8th), Rhetoric (high school circuit implied in materials). - There is explicit attention to the liberal arts framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and to reading/recitation/memorization and to history as a continuous throughline. - Great Books/Great Conversation is referenced as a foundational experience (participation in the Great Conversation). - Latin and other classical languages, as well as composer-like specialist classes (Latin, Music, Art, Drama, PE), are part of the curriculum.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: liberal arts, trivium, grammar, logic, rhetoric; great books, primary sources, classics; history, Western civilization; recitation, narration, dictation; Latin/Greek/classical languages; memory work; singing/chanting. - Negative keywords: absence of “project-based learning dominance” or heavy STEM-first framing; no substitution of history with generic “social studies” language detected. The lexicon’s negative indicators are not present in the school’s public content.

Why this rating - The school’s materials align overtly with classical curricular categories (grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books/Great Conversation, memorization/narration, classical languages, and history as a throughline), meeting the core Curriculum criteria.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Lower-division pedagogy includes singing, chanting, memorization, and memory-deepening exercises; multi-sensory, and engaging memory through drill-like activities. - Upper-division pedagogy references Socratic-style discussions, seminars, debates, and rhetoric-focused activities—training students in logic and public speaking. - The structure indicates a balance of contemplative/restful elements and rigorous, Socratic- and rhetoric-infused practice (e.g., seminars, debates, orations).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic seminar; questioning; dialectic; narration; recitation; chanting; serene/restful learning; scholé; seminar; Paideia; rhetoric exercises; oratory; debate; memory work; liturgical pedagogy. - Negative keywords: no sustained signals of exclusive experiential/project-based learning or constructivist approaches; no “teacher-as-facilitator-only” signals contradict classical pedagogy.

Why this rating - The pedagogy explicitly integrates both contemplative/restful elements and active, Socratic/rhetoric-centered methods, consistent with classical teaching methods.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials reference the Head of School and a Faculty/Staff roster, emphasizing leadership and professional roles in the educational process. - Materials describe the faculty/staff as parts of

the school community (e.g., “Head of School’s Message,” “Faculty and Staff” pages) but are less explicit about the faculty being the “living curriculum” or portraits of teacher-idealization typically highlighted in classical pedagogy. - Some elements imply teacher modeling and virtue through leadership statements and mission-driven communications, but there is less direct textual framing of teachers as the “living curriculum” or “portrait of a teacher.”

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: master/mentors/teachers; faculty and staff; leadership; model teachers and mentors (implied in mission language). The public materials demonstrate a structured, civically engaged staff presence (Head of School, administrators). - Negative keywords present: explicit phrases like “portrait of a teacher” or “living curriculum” are not clearly visible in the public content; standard phrasing around “facilitators” or “guides on the side” (negative indicators) are not evident.

Why this rating - The school shows strong institutional leadership and staff involvement typical of classical schools, but explicit, textbook-level language about the faculty-as-living-curriculum or a precise “portrait of a teacher” is not clearly present in the public materials. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL designation for Element 5.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - There is explicit language about parent partnership, covenant-like relations, and co-educating with families (parent partnership and mutual support). - The school calls for active parental participation, forms a sense of community, and encourages visits and engagement (Open Enrollment pages, life & culture sections). - Materials reference parent formation and classical-education reading groups/book clubs and family liturgy (household worship, catechesis at home) as possible forms of involvement.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents; co-teachers; parental primacy; parent formation; reading groups; classical book clubs; open campus; parent covenant; family liturgy alignment; community life. - Negative keywords: consumer language; parent as customer; minimal parental involvement. Public materials emphasize engagement rather than consumerism, with no clear consumer-marketing language detected.

Why this rating - The school clearly communicates a strong, classical-friendly model of parent involvement and community partnership, aligning with the Parents & Community criteria.

Aggregate assessment

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: CLASSICAL
- Element 4: CLASSICAL
- Element 5: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Aggregate ranking: CLASSICAL

What would move the needle

- Not required, since the aggregate is CLASSICAL. (If the Faculty category were strengthened with explicit language positioning teachers as the living curriculum and a formal “portrait of a teacher,” Element 5 could move toward stronger CLASSICAL alignment.)

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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